



*Budapest was once
two cities – Buda on
the right bank of the
River Danube, and Pest
on the left bank.*

INDUSTRIAL LIFE
Czechia is central Europe's most industrialized country, with a large car manufacturing sector. It is renowned for its centuries-old glass industry and also produces some of the world's best-known beers. Pilsner lager, for example, originated in the town of Plzeň, while Budweiser beer has been brewed at České Budějovice for more than a century.

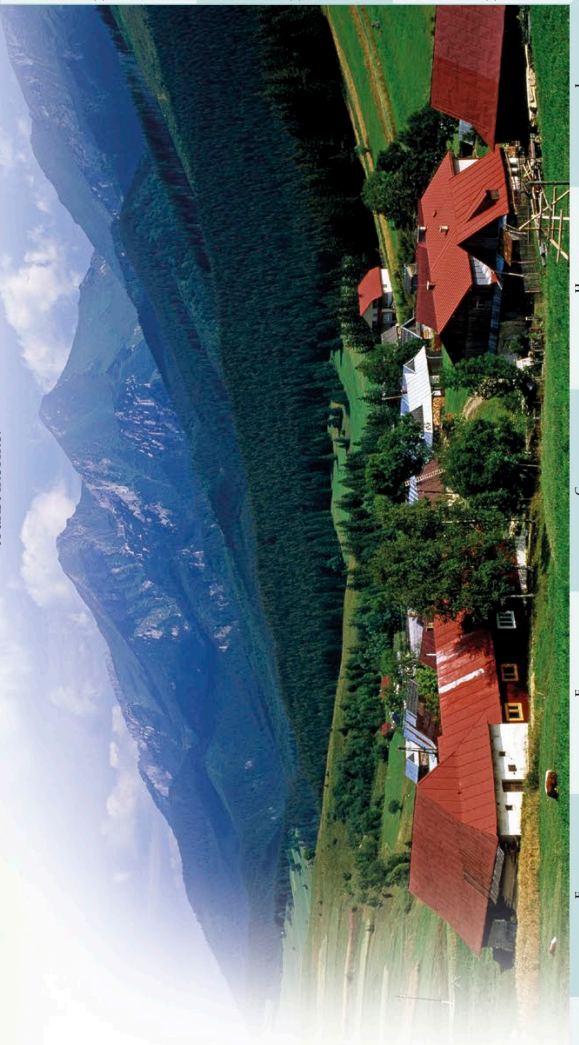


HOT SPRINGS

A land of fertile plains, Hungary is also famous for its numerous hot springs. In the capital city of Budapest, there are more than 100 hot springs. The warm waters rise naturally from the ground, and spas and baths are centred on these springs. They are as popular today as they were centuries ago, when the Romans used the hot springs on the Buda side of the city.

Széchenyi baths in Budapest has outdoor pools open all year.

LANDSCAPE OF SLOVAKIA
Slovakia is divided between a fertile, lowland south and a more rugged, mountainous north. The country is far more rural than its industrial neighbour, Czechia. Most Slovaks live in small towns and mountain villages. The Tatras Mountains in the north are popular with skiers and hikers, who bring in much-needed tourist income.



FOLK CULTURE
Traditional folk culture is still preserved in Slovakia, and is seen as an essential part of regional identity. Throughout the year, especially during the summer months, folk festivals are held in many towns. The people dress up in their colourful regional folk costumes, play traditional instruments, and sing and dance.

